

Project Loon

Project Loon is Google's version of cell phone towers in the stratosphere, with balloons instead of drones. At high altitudes, the balloons can avoid storms, birds, and aeroplane traffic. The winds are also a lot more predictable there. The balloons can be directed up or down to make use of air currents. In early tests, the balloons burst when they got too high. They also had problems with leaks. Now, however, the design has been improved and balloons can stay airborne for more than 100 days.

Disaster relief ▽

The balloons are relatively cheap and quick to build. This is especially important for disaster relief projects, when local infrastructure may have been wiped out and people urgently need the ability to communicate.

